

Fadal VMC 4020 for Oil & Gas

CNC vertical mill for precision milling, drilling, and contouring on prototypes through medium production runs. This paper covers what the machine does, the oil & gas parts we produce with it, the alloys we run, the tolerances and finishes oil & gas buyers expect, and the documentation package.



Pistol Whiskers · 20" W × 48" L × 24" H workpiece envelope · CNC vertical machining center

Executive summary

Machine: Fadal VMC 4020-906-1 (shop nickname: *Pistol Whiskers*). CNC vertical machining center at B&R Productions, running from our New Waverly, Texas shop under an ISO 9001:2015 quality system.

Application: CNC vertical mill for precision milling, drilling, and contouring on prototypes through medium production runs for Oil & Gas customers — Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

Envelope: 20" W × 48" L × 24" H workpiece envelope. **Tolerance:** ±0.0005" routine on critical features.

Traceability: Material by heat and lot on every job.

The machine, in context

The Fadal 4020 is the workhorse of American medium-envelope CNC milling — rigid, well-understood, and forgiving with the harder alloys. Pistol Whiskers is our go-to for prototype work, repair parts, and small-to-medium

production runs where the part fits inside the envelope. It handles complex pocketing, milled features, and multi-face setups without flinching on the alloys that would chatter marginal equipment.

Full spec table

Model	Fadal VMC 4020-906-1 ("Pistol Whiskers")
Type	3-axis CNC vertical machining center
Workpiece envelope	20" W × 48" L × 24" H
Axis travels	Fadal 4020 platform — 40" X, 20" Y, 20" Z (typical)
Spindle taper / speed	CAT 40 tooling; up to 7,500 RPM (platform typical)
Automatic tool changer	21-tool ATC (platform typical)
Control	Fadal CNC-88 / Format 2
Tolerance capability	±0.0005" routine on critical features
Materials	Aluminum, stainless, tool steel, 4140/4340, Inconel, Hastelloy, titanium

Who this serves in Oil & Gas

Typical buyer: Frac fleet operators, wellhead crews, wireline and coil-tubing service companies, downhole tool manufacturers, completion tool OEMs, subsea equipment vendors, produced-water handling equipment suppliers.

What's hard about oil & gas work: Chloride stress-corrosion cracking, sour service (H2S), high-cycle pressure loading, exotic superalloys, and rig-down clocks that turn every hour into money. Documentation trails required for API-adjacent work.

Typical Oil & Gas parts we produce on Pistol Whiskers

- Valve body machining (small and medium, gate/ball/safety)
- Wellhead adapters and hub connectors under 20" envelope
- Choke bodies with complex internal geometry
- Manifold blocks and BOP-adjacent hardware
- Reverse-engineered discontinued OEM parts

Above list is representative; if your part isn't shown, call and ask — most oilfield / aerospace / defense / industrial turned or milled work fits somewhere in the shop.

Alloys we run for Oil & Gas

Standard range: Inconel 718 (aged and annealed) · Inconel 625 · Super Duplex 2507 (UNS S32750) · Duplex 2205 · 17-4 PH (all conditions H900 to H1150) · Monel K-500 · Nitronic 50/60 · F22 · F91 · 4130/4140.

Alloy behavior is different in oilfield service. Inconel 718 in the aged condition (H900, roughly 40-45 HRC) is a different machining problem than annealed 718 — feeds, speeds, and tool geometry all shift. Super Duplex 2507 machined without cutting-temperature control develops brittle intermetallics that destroy the chloride-resistance the alloy was chosen for; a shop that shrugs when you ask about phase balance is a shop that will quietly ruin your part. 17-4 PH in Condition A machines like a well-behaved stainless; in H900 it's a different animal. Every one of these alloys we run weekly, not experimentally.

What "we run these weekly" means: we stock or reliably source the common alloys in the industry's typical spec range. Sharp tooling, proven feeds and speeds, and process control specific to each alloy family. Your part is not the one we're experimenting on.

Tolerance and finish expectations in Oil & Gas

±0.0005" routine on critical sealing and mating surfaces. Bore concentricity and roundness held tighter than most job-shop lathes can offer. Surface-finish targets measured with a profilometer, not estimated. For seat grooves and packing bores, finish is often the difference between a sealing part and a leak-path.

Documentation and quality workflow

Material traceability by heat and lot on every job — non-negotiable for API-adjacent work. First-article layout and CMM verification standard. Customer-specific ITPs (Inspection and Test Plans) supported. PPAP-style packages produced on demand. Certificate of conformance issued with delivery.

Response time and emergency work

Rig-down and fleet-down work prioritized over routine production. Same-day and next-day realistic when material is on the shelf. Call (936) 291-7827 direct — say "rig-down" and the phone gets to the shop floor. For emergency work off-hours, leave a voicemail; we route emergencies.

How we compare

Compared to buying finished components from an OEM: we're faster for one-offs and low-volume runs, and we hold traceability the OEM often won't share when you're outside their warranty window. Compared to a commodity job shop: we run the alloys weekly and won't ruin your metallurgy on cutting-temperature mistakes.

Working with B&R Productions

New customer or existing, the process starts the same way: call (936) 291-7827 or send a print through the quote form. Prints are accepted as PDF, STEP, IGES, DWG, or DXF; if you only have a sample part, we reverse-engineer routinely. NDAs on request. ITAR-controlled prints handled under document control with prints staying in-shop.

Quotes typically come back within 24 hours for standard work, same-day for repeat customers on stocked materials, and near-immediately by phone for emergency and rig-down situations. Lead times are quoted honestly — we don't promise Wednesday and deliver next month.

Ready to talk about your Oil & Gas work?

Send us a print or a sample photo and specs. Emergencies: call direct and say "rig-down."

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